

Deal 1 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners

A

K

7

4

♣

♣

♣

♣

♣

A

Q

10

6

2

♦

8

3

♠

♠

♠

♠

7

5

♥

♥

♥

♥

♥

9

5

7

5

3

A

K

5

2

A

K

4

3

♥

Count Sure Winners

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners

Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Deal 3 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners

A

8

6

5

3

♣

♣

♣

♣

♣

8

6

5

2

♦

9

7

♠

♠

♠

♠

♠

4

3

♥

♥

♥

♥

Q

J

9

A

K

4

K

Q

3

A

7

5

2

♥

Count Sure Winners

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners

Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: South

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

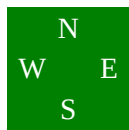
♠ J 9 7
 ♥ Q 10 9 6
 ♦ J 9
 ♣ J 10 6 2

♠ A K 5 2

♥ A K 4 3

♦ 7 5 3

♣ 9 5



♠ Q 10 6 4

♥ J 8 2

♦ K 8 4

♣ Q 8 3

♠ 8 3

♥ 7 5

♦ A Q 10 6 2

♣ A K 7 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♣
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North

Again don't hold up. Take the ♠ K and lead another small ♦, finessing with dummy's ♦ Q. Happily this time the finesse works, and even more happily both defenders follow suit. That means the rest of the ♦s are good and you make an overtrick.

This was just a normal suit-establishment Deal.

If looked different because of the two finesses you took.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠ 4.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 7

You need two more winners. They cannot possibly come from ♠s, ♥s, or ♣s since one defender must hold at least 4 cards in each of those suits. So your two extra winners must come from the ♦ suit.

There is no reason to hold up on the ♠ since the ♥ and ♣ suits also have just two stoppers. You win the ♠ A.

Your best play next is to finesse the ♦ 10. This may gain a trick by virtue of the finesse if East happens to hold the ♦ J, but primarily you are working to establish the ♦ suit. Assume West wins the ♦ J and returns a ♠.

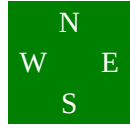
Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 7
 ♥ 4 3
 ♦ 8 6 5 2
 ♣ A 8 6 5 3

♠ A 8 5
 ♥ Q 10 9 6
 ♦ Q J 9
 ♣ 10 7 4



♠ K Q 3
 ♥ A 7 5 2
 ♦ A K 4
 ♣ Q J 9

♠ J 10 6 4 2
 ♥ K J 8
 ♦ 10 7 3
 ♣ K 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	Pass	1♣	Pass
2♣	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by East			

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♠4. North puts on the ♠A and returns the ♠8.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 6

Needing three more winners you are going to have to establish the ♣ suit. You are also going to have to be lucky!

You win the second ♠ and play your ♣Q. South covers with the ♣K. What do you do next?

You **DUCK**. If you take the ♣A now you will never get back to dummy to enjoy those other ♣s. So let South have the ♣K. You win his return, (probably a ♠), and play ♣J, then ♣9 to dummy's ♣A. As long as ♣s split 3-2 you will get the three winners you need.

You were prepared to lose that ♣ finesse to North so you could establish the suit in dummy.

South's play of the ♣K may have made you want to jump up with the ♣A, but you must stick to the original play of ducking one trick.

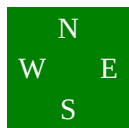
Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 10 8 2
 ♥ K 10 4
 ♦ 8 7 2
 ♣ K J 7

♠ 7 5 4
 ♥ A Q 8 7 5
 ♦ 9 6 3
 ♣ 8 4



♠ J 9 6
 ♥ J 9 2
 ♦ Q J 10
 ♣ 10 9 3 2

♠ A Q 3
 ♥ 6 3
 ♦ A K 5 4
 ♣ A Q 6 5

West	North	East	South
	Pass	Pass	1♦
Pass	1♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠2. East puts on the ♠J.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 6

You need three more winners. It is possible your fourth ♦ can be established, but that needs a 3-3 split. It's also possible that the ♣ finesse will work, and also the ♥ finesse. Since you need the ♥ finesse anyway you should go ahead and try to establish the ♥s.

Win the first trick with your ♠Q and play a low ♥, ducking in dummy. East will no doubt win a cheap trick but no matter. When you next gain the lead play your other low ♥ and finesse the ♥Q. Assume this wins (if it doesn't you will be going down for sure). Play the ♥A and if both defenders follow your other 2 ♥s are good and your contract is made.

Ducking the first ♥ and finessing the second could let you wind up with no tricks at all in the ♥ suit.

But, it is your only chance to make the contract.